Brazil. One of India's former national security advisers, Shivshankar Menon, referred to this as India 'speed dating' the global powers.[136] Singaporean diplomat and scholar Kishore Mahbubani postulates that Modi's world view is made up of genuine non-alignment, an emphasis on economic growth and the desire to rebuild ties in India's 'regional backyard'. [137] According to Mahbubani, Modi's 'genuine non-alignment' is reflected in India's good ties with and ability to secure economic investment and defence equipment from diverse countries like the United States, China, Japan, Israel, Iran, Germany, France and Russia. 'It takes great political and psychological confidence to maintain equally good relations with such sharply divided leaders,' Mahbubani observed'.[138]

French scholar Christophe Jaffrelot attributes Modi's passionate focus on foreign policy to his being a nationalist leader, just like Vajpayee. In Jaffrelot's view economic interests and South Asia are Modi's two key foreign policy priorities.[139] Like Mahbubani and Jaffrelot, Harsh Pant acknowledges that Modi has focused on strengthening ties with diverse powers like the United States, Japan and China as well as South Asian neighbours.[140] But Pant asserts that Modi seeks to dismantle non-alignment and move beyond 'ideological rhetoric' to real action. To that effect, Indian diplomats have been provided with a detailed strategic evaluation of how the Modi government sees India's place in the world and have also been encouraged to deepen and push India's economic interests.[141]

Modi's foreign policy activism in his first two years in office is reminiscent of Nehru's travels soon after India's independence. Nehru, like most Indians, believed that India shouldered a great responsibility by virtue of its size and its history. He spoke of 'the responsibility of the freedom of 400 million people of India, the responsibility of the leadership of a large part of Asia, the responsibility of being some kind of guide to vast numbers of people all over the world'. Nehru had no doubt that one day India would